From: [redacted]
[redacted]
Subject: Submission: Privacy Act Exemption for Political Parties
Date: Wednesday, 29 October 2025 7:45:00 AM

Dear Committee Secretariat,

I'm writing as a constituent in Kooyong to raise serious concerns about the exemption granted to registered political parties under the Privacy Act 1988 (Cth). I believe this exemption undermines the intent of the Australian Privacy Principles and leaves citizens vulnerable to data misuse.

As you are aware, political entities conducting "exempt political activities" are not bound by the APPs. This allows them to collect and use personal data — including mobile phone numbers — without consent, transparency, or opt-out mechanisms. These practices would be unlawful for any other organisation.

I've personally received unsolicited political messages via Yabbr, a communications platform used by campaigns and government agencies. These messages were sent using data sourced from brokers such as Equifax, Illion, Acceleon, and Thryv — aggregators of consumer information from credit applications, directories, and other sources. Despite never consenting to this use of my number, I was unable to opt out or trace the origin of the data access.

What's particularly concerning is that these communications bypass the protections offered by the Do Not Call Register. Although I have registered my number, this safeguard is rendered ineffective when political entities are exempt from its restrictions. This undermines public confidence in the Register and further erodes trust in democratic engagement.

I urge the Committee to consider reforms to the Privacy Act that would:

- Remove or narrow the exemption for political parties
- Require consent and opt-out mechanisms for all unsolicited communications
- Mandate transparency in data sourcing and usage
- Extend the protections of the Do Not Call Register to include political communications

Australians deserve the same privacy protections from political entities as they do from corporations. I would welcome the opportunity to contribute further to this discussion or provide a formal submission if appropriate.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Warm regards,

Robert Kimpton
Kooyong constituent